PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz 500 GE V8

1993–1994 · W463 · M117 5.0 V8

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Prove it's a real 500 GE**
  Check the VIN and the factory data card. Genuine trucks are W463 long-wheelbase V8s in Amethyst Blue Metallic with black/grey leather. Commenters on one US listing questioned whether an M117 was correct, so make sure the engine is original rather than a transplant.
- [ ] **AMG 6.0 claims need paperwork**
  RM Sotheby's points out that pre-merger AMG conversions are hard to verify and lookalikes exist. Look for option code ZB6 ("500 GE (AMG)") on the data card and factory documents before paying a 6.0 premium.
- [ ] **Don't panic about the front locker**
  There isn't one. The 500 GE was built with centre and rear locks only. Test that both engage and show on the dash.
- [ ] **Import and title paperwork**
  None were sold new in the US. American trucks came in privately: one documented example was cleared through Wallace test labs in 2005 at considerable cost. Make sure the title, import and compliance documents match the VIN.
- [ ] **Fuel delivery**
  Owner records on surviving trucks show fuel pumps, the fuel accumulator and filters being replaced. Ask when that was done, and expect to do it on a truck that has sat.
- [ ] **Front axle oil**
  Gear oil on the inside of the front wheels or on the brakes means axle seals. Even a low-mileage collector truck sold by RM Sotheby's needed a front-axle oil leak fixed during recommissioning.
- [ ] **Binding in tight turns**
  A truck that binds or hops in tight U-turns on pavement may simply have a lock engaged. If it's unlocked and still binds, suspect the CV joints or transfer case, as one seller did, and price the repair.
- [ ] **Rust in the usual places**
  Tailgate lower edge, door bottoms, sills, rear frame tubes and strut mounts. A rust-free original body matters more on a 446-unit truck than on any other G.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Chassis number**
  Documented 500 GEs share the model code 463.228 in the chassis number: WDB463228… on Mercedes-badged trucks (two RM Sotheby's cars and an armoured BaT car), VAG463228… on the Puch.

- [ ] **Two lockers, not three**
  Mercedes didn't offer a front differential lock on the 500 GE, so it has only the centre and rear locks. A front-lock switch suggests a later G or a conversion.
- [ ] **Body and colour**
  Long-wheelbase station wagon only. Standard trucks are Amethyst Blue metallic (DB 3338) with the bumpers, wheel-arch flares and mirror housings in the same colour. Special-request paint exists: RM Sotheby's sold one in Avantgarde Verde.
- [ ] **Interior**
  Black leather with medium-grey seat centres and door panels, and walnut on the centre console, handbrake, selector levers and door trim. Automatic, air conditioning, cruise control, sunroof and heated seats were standard.
- [ ] **AMG 6.0**
  The genuine AMG 500 GE 6.0 has a 5,959 cc M117. RM Sotheby's cites option code ZB6, '500 GE (AMG)', checked on the data card. Badges alone prove nothing.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/500ge/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks